Loubieh bi Zeit

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Flat green beans, ripe tomatoes and olive oil come together in this comforting Lebanese dish.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 1 h 10

INGREDIENTS

- 1 kg flat green beans
- 2 kg ripe tomatoes, finely chopped, with their juices
- 1 large onion, grated
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tsp salt, adjusted to taste
- 1 tsp red capsicum paste
- 1 tbsp chili paste
- 1 tbsp tomato paste
- Water, only if needed *(optional)*

METHOD

1. Prepare the beans. Wash the flat beans, trim the ends and remove any tough strings. Cut into approximately 4–5 cm pieces.
2. Soften the onion. Heat the olive oil in a large, heavy pot over medium heat. Add the grated onion and cook for approximately 5–7 minutes, stirring occasionally, until softened.
3. Cook the beans first. Add the flat beans and toss to coat in the oil and onion. Cover and cook over medium-low heat for 10–15 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the beans begin to soften and turn translucent. Add a small splash of water only if they start to catch.
4. Stir in the red capsicum paste, chili paste and tomato paste until evenly distributed.
5. Add the tomatoes. Add the chopped tomatoes and all their juices, followed by the salt. Stir gently, cover and bring to a simmer. Juicy, ripe tomatoes may provide all the liquid needed.
6. Cook slowly. Reduce the heat and simmer gently for approximately 45 minutes, until the beans are very tender and the tomatoes have formed a rich sauce. Stir occasionally and check the liquid level. Add water in small amounts only if the pot becomes dry before the beans are cooked. If the sauce is too loose, uncover towards the end to reduce it.
7. Refrigerate. Taste and adjust the salt. Transfer to shallow containers and refrigerate promptly. Chill for at least 1 hour, or until cold.
8. Serve cold. Spoon into a serving dish with the tomato sauce and enjoy with Lebanese bread.

Tip

Let the beans turn translucent first. Give them their full 10–15 minutes before adding the tomatoes.